



breakfast.

At the launch of my book on him, he came down an hour early from his room at the Maurya Sheraton in Delhi, mingled with the crowd, and didn't complain once about being mobbed. He enjoyed every minute of those three hours on October 19, 2016. On stage, he was joined by Kapil, Sehwag, Anil Kumble and Ravi Shastri. I still cherish the tweet he posted that day:

"Humbled to have a book written about me by @bradsobers. Thank you for this book sir #DrivenLikeVirat"

And then there was that unforgettable morning at Kotla — December 19, 2006. Day three of a Ranji Trophy match. Delhi was following on, 103 for five, with Virat on 40 and Puneet Bisht on 28. Virat had lost his father the previous night but insisted on playing. Manhas, the captain, had told him to go home. Virat refused. "Have to save the follow-on," he said.

K. BHAGYA PRAKASH



Humble tribute: Virat Kohli touches Bishan Singh Bedi's feet at the inaugural Bedi Lecture in 2017, shortly after arriving late — visibly apologetic, and deeply honoured. PTI

I reached early and met coach Chetan Chauhan and Manhas outside the dressing room. Chauhan asked me to speak with Virat. I spent 10 minutes with him and saw, up close, his resolve to put the team first — even in a moment of personal grief. The Karnataka team shared his sorrow before he padded up. He scored 90 before being given out caught behind. Only then did he leave for his father's cremation.

That day, Virat took a decisive step in his journey to play for India.

It's been a privilege to follow his career and share these moments. Test cricket won't be the same without Virat Kohli.